

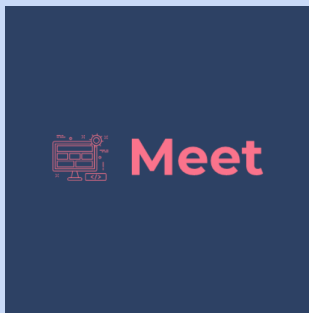
Case Study of My Meet Project

Credits

Lead Developer: Alexander Eggleston

Tutor: Ezequiel De Simone

Mentor: Enrique Gonzalez



A picture of Meet's logo.

Purpose and Context

Met was created as a part of my Full-Stack Immersion Course with CareerFoundry. It is a personal project that was used to introduce me to test-driven development, serverless functions, object-oriented programming, progressive web apps, and data visualization.

Overview

Meet is a project I developed through test-driven development. It exists to give users access to local and worldwide events, as well as scheduling attendance. This app also utilizes data visualization to create dynamic charts for the user.

A picture of the source code managing events in Meet.

```
// src/components/Event.jsx
import React, { useState } from 'react';

const Event = ({ event }) => {
  const [showDetails, setShowDetails] = useState(false);
  return (
    <li className="event">
      <h2>{event && event.summary}</h2>
      <p>{event && event.location}</p>
      <p>{event && new Date(event.created).toUTCString()}</p>
      {showDetails ? (
        <p className="details">{event && event.description}</p>
      ) : null}
      <button
        className="details-btn"
        onClick={() => {
          showDetails ? setShowDetails(false) : setShowDetails(true);
        }}
      >
        {showDetails ? 'hide details' : 'show details'}
      </button>
    </li>
  );
};

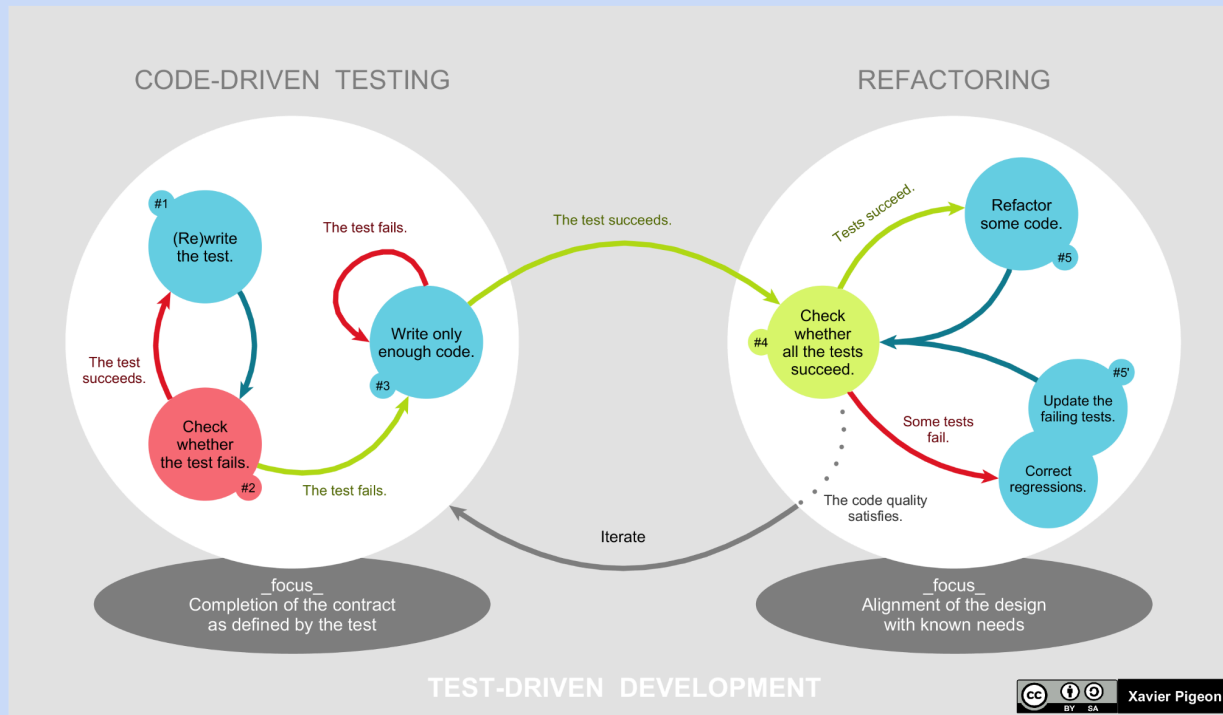
export default Event;
```

Objective

The main objective of the Meet project was to introduce myself to test-driven development, which is an approach to development predicated on knowing what functionality is necessary before adding the bells and whistles.

Duration

This project was only 10 deliverable chunks, average size for my projects during CareerFoundry. The final project was delivered just on time.



A graphic explaining test-driven development, by Xavier Pigeon, shared under [Creative Commons 4.0 International Share-Alike license](#).

Development

The development of Meet began a while before it was being programmed, as my introduction to the testing mindset, I was to write user stories for the key features of Meet. These stories primed my thought process for function-first programming. After that, I was introduced to Vite, which is a build tool meant for deploying apps quickly and easily. I actually built and deployed a template React application through Vite so I could get used to working with it!



The Vite logo.

Development cont'd.

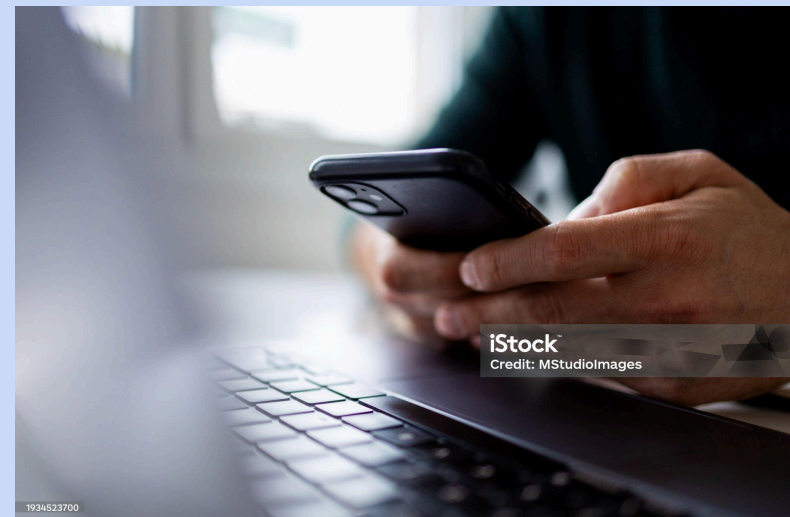
As well as a bunch of work with testing and Vite, I got to be introduced to serverless functions, which are less-so serverless, and more-so functions handled by an external server. They are still written by the developer, but if one uses, for example, Amazon Web Services (I did), then Amazon servers are handling the authentication of users accessing a Google Calendar.

Object-Oriented Programming

Meet also served as a minor intro to object-oriented programming, using the class system in Javascript to create various Alerts for certain situations. For example, when a user searches the name of an event that does not exist, there is an alert that no such event exists.

Progressive Web Applications

To be short, a Progressive Web App is a downloadable website. When you open a site like Facebook through your phone's internet browser, you receive a prompt asking you to download Facebook. When you do this, the Facebook app goes to your home screen and you can open it without the browser. Now, for this exact example, Facebook does have a separately developed app for phones, but the idea is easier to get across with a recognizable name. Meet is a progressive web app, you can open it on your phone through the browser, and then add it to your home screen.



Challenges

In the serverless authentication code, there was an issue with syntax that caused the entire app to fail to find any data. I had no idea what caused the issue, as it was not such a large error that the app would not run, it just interfered with fetching data. I could not figure out where that issue was coming from, until I got on call with my mentor Enrique Gonzalez, and he was able to spot it while we were looking over the code together. A special thank you to him here, as this project would never have worked without his keen eye.



Reflection

Meet was an introduction to many new methods and technologies, most of which I had never before heard of. In some of my earlier projects, I would utilize something I had absorbed through osmosis, like Javascript. Even if you do not program, you've likely heard of it, but I had never heard of test-driven development or serverless functions before this project. So, I would say I am thankful for Meet because of what I was able to learn while I worked on it.